NQ FUTURES · MINDSET · KEY POINTS

MalikTrades

The Boom-and-Bust Cycle

What separates profitable traders from the rest

A working digest, compiled for personal study

THE PATTERN

Why most traders make money, then give it back

Roughly 99% of traders stay unprofitable. The strategy is rarely the problem. What separates them from the consistently profitable 1% is how they manage themselves after a win and after a loss.

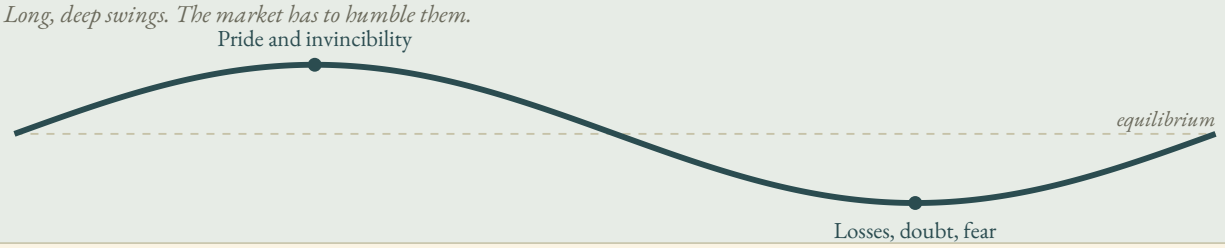
> *"The boom-and-bust cycle is a reflection of poor psychology: a trader who doesn't know how to manage themselves, so they get run by the market."*

THE CYCLE

The two paths, side by side

99% of traders

Long, deep swings. The market has to humble them.



The top 1%

Same emotions, much shorter swings. They reset themselves fast, before the next trade.



How the average trader's loop runs:

A few wins	Pride, overconfidence	Risk ignored, plan dropped	Loss after loss	Doubt, fear	Back to plan, repeat

THE KEY POINTS

What the top 1% do differently

1 Wins are the dangerous moment
Praise and profit feed pride. Pride makes you minimize the risks, force low-quality trades and drift from the plan, and that is what triggers the losing streak.

2 Humble yourself after a win
Be grateful, then remind yourself of the risks and of the last time a win pulled you off plan. The aim is to return to equilibrium, not to beat yourself up below it.

3 Lift yourself after a loss
A loss is a hot-stove reminder to stick to your proven process, not the end of the world. Remember how much you have learned and built.

4 Expectations are the anchor
You only feel elated or crushed because you expected the trade to give you something. Name those expectations before you trade and let them go, so the swings flatten.

5 One question at every entry
Does this trade align with my trading plan? Asked from equilibrium, not greed or fear, it gives a clear yes or no.

THE ROUTINE

Before and after every trade

BEFORE	Remove the anchor: name your expectations and ground them.
WIN	Humble yourself back to equilibrium. Remember the risks.
LOSS	Lift yourself back to equilibrium. Stick to the process.
ENTRY	Ask: does this trade align with my plan?

The goal is to shift from an outcome-based trader, who swings with every result, to a process-based trader, who sticks to the plan and lets consistency compound.